RIMPA Global Hackathon 2026

19-21 October

Participant Hack Pack

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Thank you for joining the RIMPA Global Hackathon 2026!

Get ready for an exhilarating experience organised by the Records and Information Management Practitioners Alliance (RIMPA Global), the longest-serving peak body for information industry practitioners in the Southern Hemisphere.

Inside this Hack Pack, you'll find all the exciting event details and participant requirements to ensure you're ready for this innovative journey.



We acknowledge the Traditional Custodians of this land, and recognise their continuing connection to land, waters and culture. We pay our respects to Elders past and present.

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01. About The Hackathon

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What is a Hackathon?



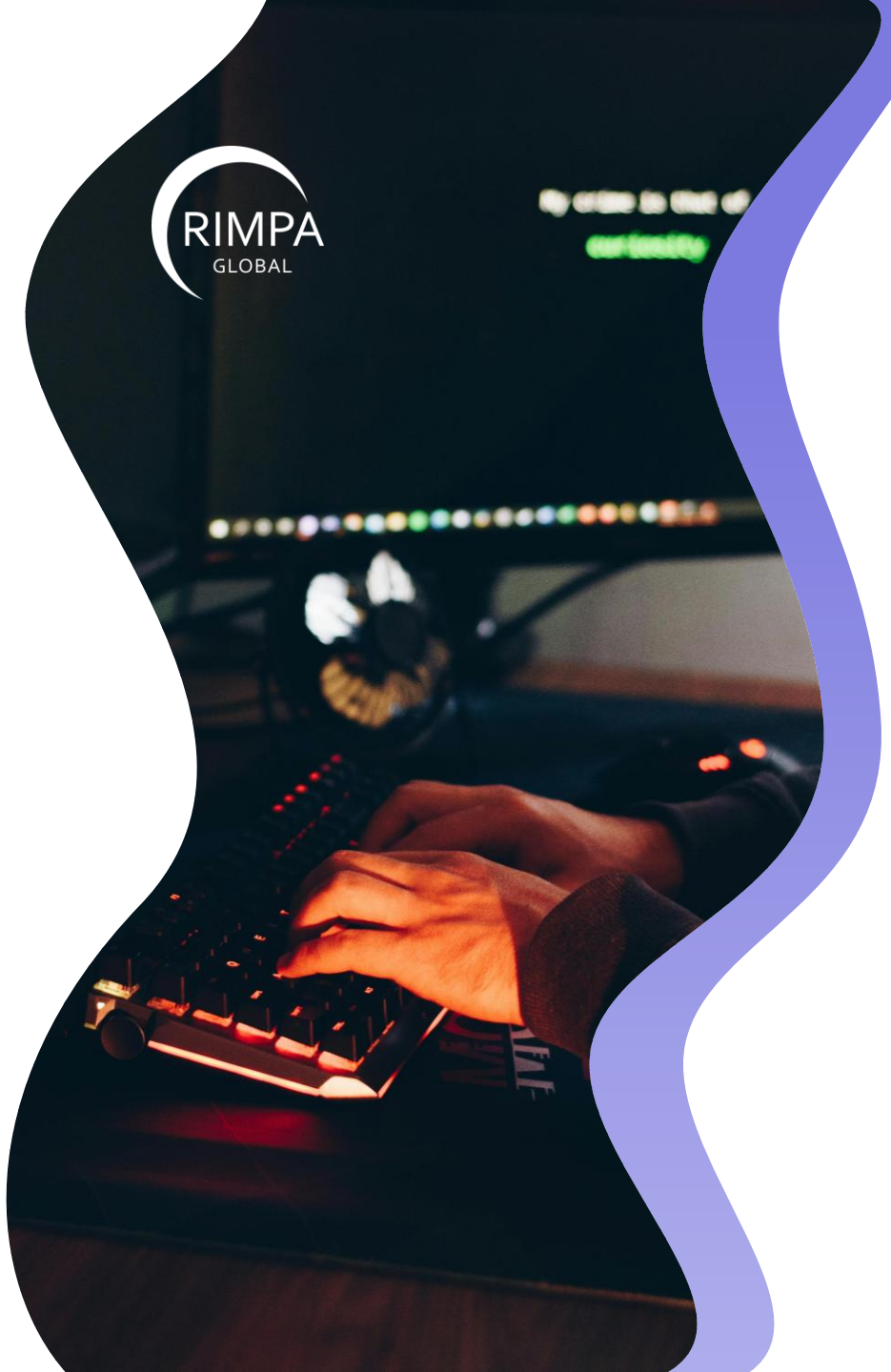
A hackathon is an exciting and collaborative event where people from diverse backgrounds come together to solve problems and create innovative solutions within a limited timeframe. Participants form teams to tackle specific challenges, pooling their skills and resources to rapidly prototype and develop practical outcomes.

Over 24 hours, teams brainstorm, design, and build applications or concepts, refining their ideas through quick and iterative problem-solving. At the end, solutions are presented to a panel of judges, with prizes awarded for creativity, functionality, practicality and innovation.

Beyond competition, hackathons foster collaboration, learning, and networking, offering a dynamic environment for creativity and real-world problem-solving

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Hackathon Problem Statement

How might we build information management know-how into AI so that users can better recognise and manage bias, misinformation, and disinformation?

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The Challenge

Bias, misinformation, and disinformation pose serious challenges for information management professionals by reducing information quality and authenticity, undermining public trust, and weakening organisational integrity. These risks are increasingly amplified by AI technologies, which can rapidly generate and spread misleading content at scale. As a result, workflows are disrupted, verification demands grow, and decision-making becomes more difficult as it becomes harder to distinguish reliable information from false, emotive, or biased material.

Your challenge is now to consider:

- How is the use of AI in organisations leading to these problems?
- What are the long-term risks for records and archives collections that need to be mitigated?
- What information management skills and practices could guard against bias, misinformation, and disinformation?
- How can skills, practices, associated standards and protocols be implemented to provide a solution?
- How can the solution help information managers play a strategic role in supporting AI initiatives and use?

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The Prize

Here's what awaits you in this unparalleled event:

1) **First Place: $10,000 AUD**

But that's not all! The winning team will be showered with additional benefits, including:

1) **Recognition in our email newsletter and social platforms, reaching out to over 3000+ subscribers:** Your team and project will be featured in a special announcement, giving you valuable exposure.

2) Exclusive mentorship & networking: Winners gain one-on-one mentorship with industry experts and exclusive networking at the RIMPA Live Convention 2026, connecting with leaders, investors, and potential employers.

3) The opportunity for your solution to make a difference. Your groundbreaking work will be considered by influential stakeholders, potentially leading to real-world implementation and impact.

Prize splitting
Please note it is up to the winning team to determine how the prize is to be split/allocated

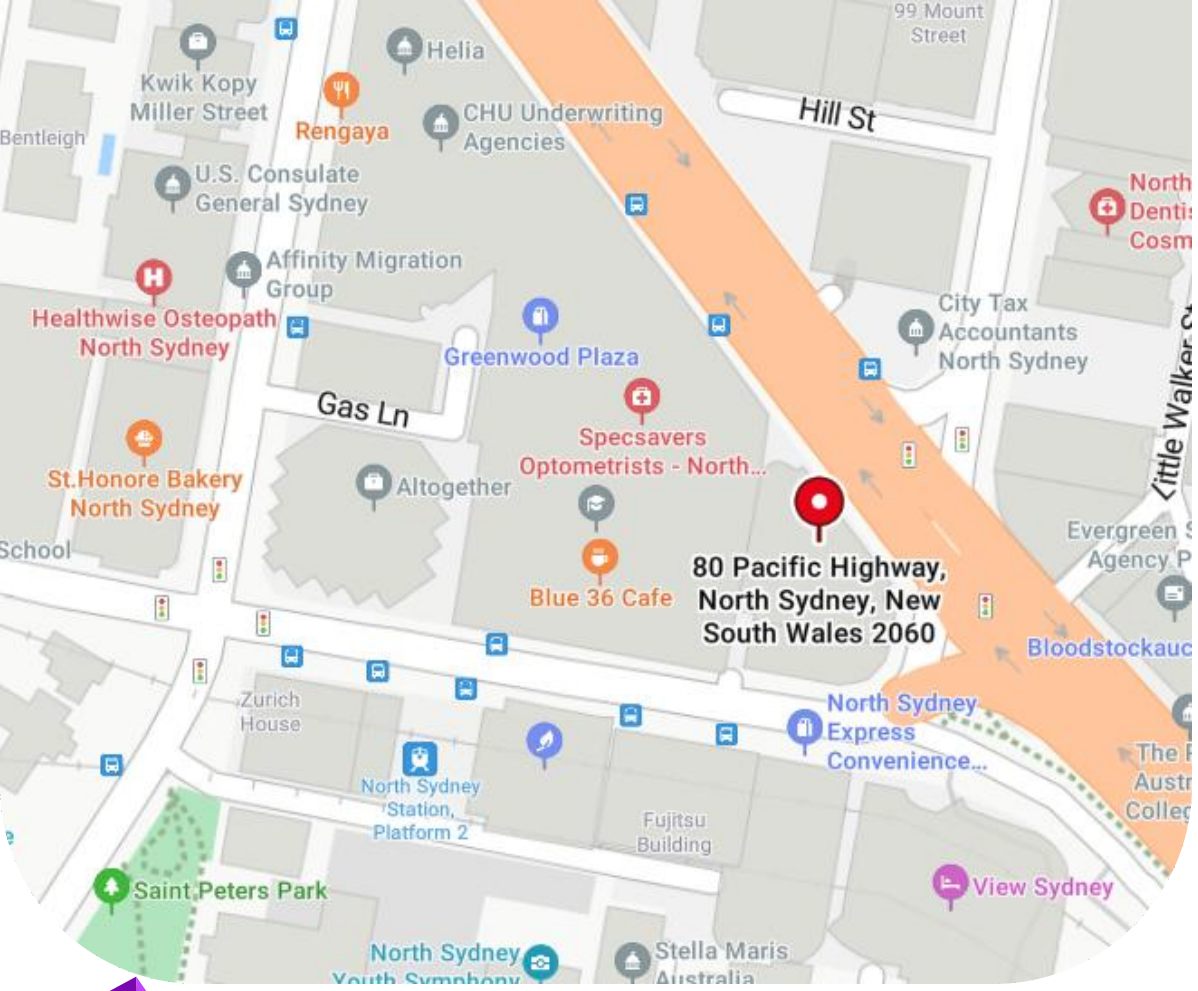
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02. The Logistics

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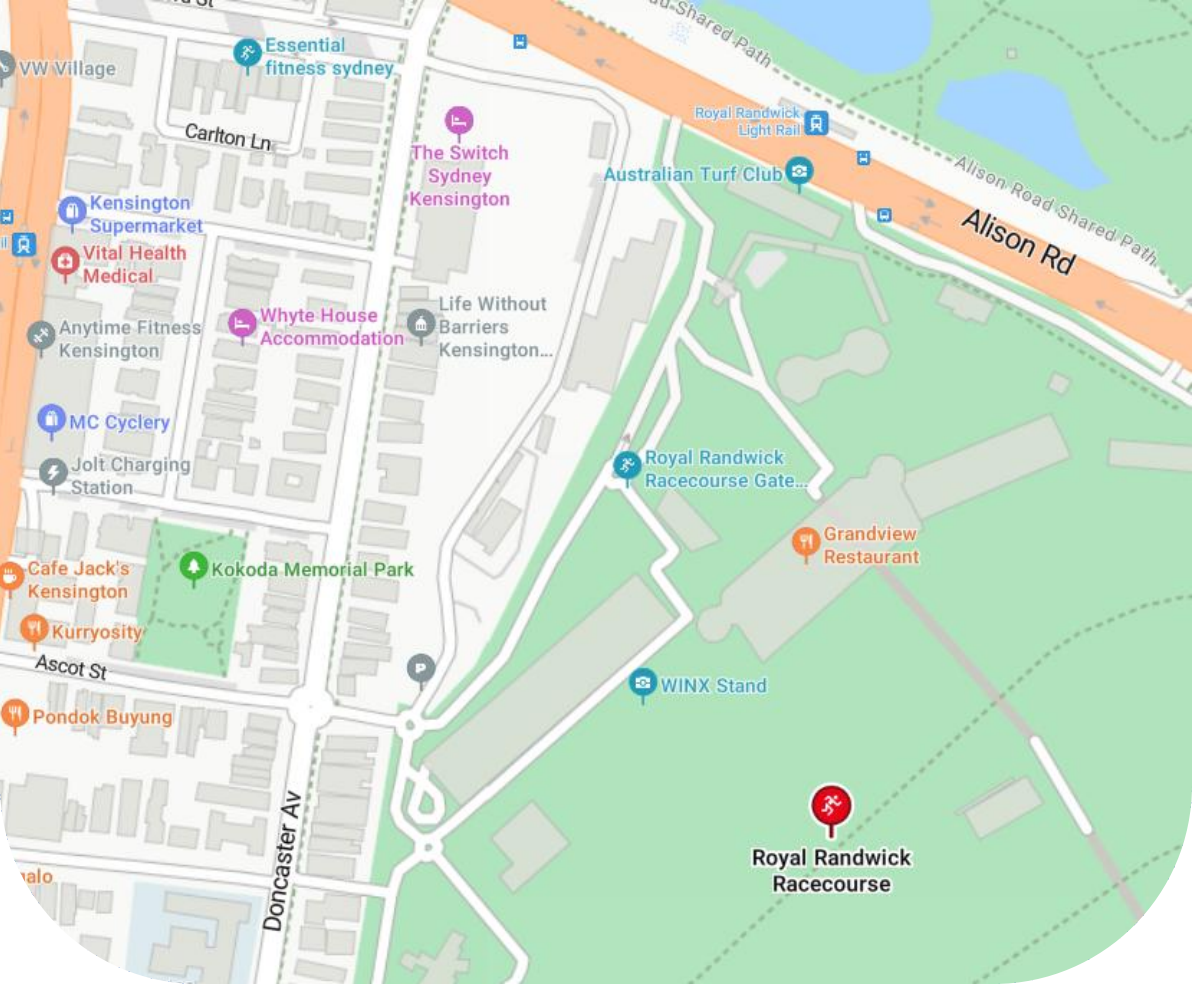
Logistics Day 1

Venue

OpenText Offices
Level 6, 80 Pacific Highway, North Sydney
Contact: admin@rimpa.com.au

When

Monday 19 October – 07:30 - 17:00 AEST
Close to North Sydney Station
Lunch Provided



Logistics Days 2 & 3

Venue

Royal Randwick Racecourse
Alison Road, Randwick, NSW, 2031
Contact: admin@rimpa.com.au

When

Tuesday, 20 October – 08:00AM – 13:30PM AEST
Day 2 – Hackathon Judging
Day 2 – Shortlist Notified by 5pm

Wednesday, 21 October – 04:00 – 11:30PM
Day 3:
04:00PM: RIMPA Live 2026 Shortlisted Finalist Presentations on stage for an Audience
06:30PM: Winner Announced at the Diamond Ball (Black-Tie Event)

Participants are invited to attend the RIMPA Live Convention 2026 while awaiting the outcome of the judging.

03. Guidance & Resources

Please note advice and reference material are for guidance only and are not mandatory.

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Let’s learn more about the challenge

Consider:

- What could be examples of AI bias, misinformation and disinformation facing society?
- What criteria would help identify bias, misinformation and disinformation?
- What legal, historical and personal risks could misinformation cause?
- What value do we place on the integrity, reliability and accuracy of AI results now and in the future?
- What ‘know how’ do information managers have that could address the problem?
- How can we bring all of these contexts and issues into a solution?
- Could AI actually help with the solution?

What might a solution look like?

- Best practice guide
- Methodology, strategy or protocol
- Specification,algorithms or formula



How to Solve Problems

Participating in a hackathon requires creativity, teamwork, and a methodical approach to problem-solving. Here's a concise guide to help you navigate the challenges:

During a hackathon, it's crucial to break down the problem into manageable parts, brainstorm innovative solutions, and collaborate effectively with your team. Prioritise communication, stay organised, and always keep the end-user in mind. Testing and iterating on your solution will lead to a polished final product.

Key Tips

- Define the problem clearly
- Break the problem into smaller tasks
- Brainstorm multiple solutions
- Prioritise ideas based on feasibility and impact
- Divide tasks among team members
- Maintain open and continuous communication
- Create prototypes and test early
- Be open to feedback and iterate
- Keep the end-user in mind throughout the process

Potential Reference Resources - *ITS YOUR CHOICE to consider the following materials, this is not mandatory reading*

Australia: records and archives guidance

National Archives of Australia
Information management for records created using AI technologies
Guidance on managing AI-generated records

National Archives of Australia
Information management for current, emerging and critical technologies
Guidance on managing emerging technology records

National Archives of Australia
Digital Preservation Policy
NAA's digital records preservation framework

Digital Transformation Agency
AI impact assessment tool: transparency and explainability
Guidance on AI transparency and explainability

Australian Signals Directorate
Content credentials: strengthening multimedia integrity in the generative AI era
Guidance on verifying AI media authenticity

Australia: information integrity and misinformation

ACMA
Digital platforms' efforts to combat disinformation and misinformation
Report on platforms' anti-disinformation efforts

DIGI
Australian Code of Practice on Disinformation and Misinformation
Industry code to reduce mis/disinformation

Australian Government
Australian Government response: Senate Select Committee on Adopting AI
Government response to the Senate AI inquiry

GovTech Review
How the Australian Government can boost cybersecurity awareness
Case for unified cybersecurity awareness

New Zealand

Archives New Zealand
Artificial intelligence and public records
AI outputs are public records (NZ)

New Zealand Government
Responsible AI Guidance for the Public Service: GenAI
Public service guidance on GenAI use

United Kingdom and Ireland

Archives and Records Association UK & Ireland
AI Preparedness Guidelines for Archivists
Guidelines to prepare archives for AI

The National Archives (UK)
Using AI for digital selection in government
Evaluating AI for records selection

Content provenance and authenticity standards

C2PA
Coalition for Content Provenance and Authenticity: technical specification
Technical standard for content provenance (source and history)

Content Credentials
Content Credentials
Tool to verify media provenance (source and history)

AI ethics and fluency

Georgetown University
Artificial Intelligence (Generative) Resources: Ethics & AI
Library guide on generative AI ethics

Gartner
Lack of Semantics Causes Inaccurate AI Agents and Wasted Spending
Semantics improves AI agent accuracy

University of Sydney (YouTube)
24 hr AI conference: AI fluency with the University of Sydney
Conference session on AI fluency

LinkedIn, Marina Hassapopoulou
Image enhancement in archives and reinterpretation
AI image enhancement used in archives

LinkedIn, D Chaffey
Problematic Image sharpening
Case of problematic AI image sharpening

ABC News
Error by AI scribe during medical appointment leaves patient devastated
AI scribe error harmed a patient's record

Optional background (general information management)

State Records NSW
Identifying and managing high-value and high-risk records, information and data
Managing high-value, high-risk records (NSW)

Public Record Office Victoria
High value, high risk records
Managing high-value, high-risk records (VIC)

04. How to Create a Team

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How to Create the Best Team

Building the right team is essential for success in a hackathon. A well-balanced team with diverse skills, clear communication, and strong collaboration can tackle challenges more effectively and creatively.

When assembling your team, look for complementary skills, shared goals, and good chemistry. Encourage open communication and ensure everyone has a role that leverages their strengths. Foster a collaborative and supportive environment to maximise productivity and innovation.

Key Tips

- **Choose team members with diverse skills**
- **Ensure a mix of developers, designers, and strategists**
- **Align on common goals and vision**
- **Prioritise good communication skills**
- **Foster a collaborative team culture**
- **Assign clear roles and responsibilities**
- **Encourage open idea sharing and brainstorming**
- **Balance experienced and novice members**
- **Maintain flexibility and adaptability**
- **Build team chemistry and trust**

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Which Person Are You?

Your team needs a combination of skills to be successful. We recommend a team consisting of a mix of expertise:

01

HACKER/DESIGNER

A team member who will code or build your solution - more technical skills.

02

HIPSTER/BUILDER

A team member with design skills that help communicate through good design and communication.

03

HUSTLER/STORYTELLER

This is the salesperson of the team - they will "sell" the idea and get people excited.

04

HUMANITARIAN/EXPERT

A team member with good research and analysis skills, the humanitarian represents the community and other stakeholders.

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05. Making Your Pitch

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How to Deliver the Perfect Pitch

Delivering a compelling pitch is crucial to impressing the judges and showcasing your team's hard work. A successful pitch is clear, concise, and engaging, highlighting your solution's uniqueness and potential impact.

Practice your delivery to ensure smooth communication, engage with the audience by telling a story, and use visuals effectively. Emphasise the problem, your solution, and its benefits. Be confident and remember to address potential questions or concerns proactively.

Key Tips

- **Start with a strong opening**
- **Clearly define the problem**
- **Explain your solution succinctly**
- **Highlight the uniqueness of your approach**
- **Showcase a demo or prototype**
- **Focus on the benefits and impact**
- **Use visuals to enhance understanding**
- **Keep the pitch within the time limit**
- **Prepare for potential questions**
- **Close with a memorable statement or call to action**

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The Perfect Pitch

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What to present

You need to start with what problem you are solving and provide a brief introduction to your solution.

Then you can deliver a walkthrough of your product or plan, and show how it solves the problem.

Finally you can talk about the market for your product and the budget for development. Keep in mind, you are engaging the community in the local area - you know the people and the businesses here.

How to present

Think about who will present - a single person or all your team.

Be sure to introduce yourself and your team and confidently speak to the audience and judges.

You can write notes or show your canvas. Remember, you only have 5 minutes to present your ENTIRE idea.

What's on the stage?

There will be a lectern, a microphone at the desk and an HDMI cable to connect your laptop. You will need to bring HDMI adaptors if you need them.

If you have a laptop, please bring it along and we can connect you to the Wi-Fi network.

- The Secret to Successfully Pitching an Idea
- How to give the perfect pitch

06. Preparation For The Day

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What to Bring on the Day

Being well-prepared can make your hackathon experience smooth and enjoyable. Bringing the right tools and essentials ensures you can focus on creating and collaborating effectively without unnecessary distractions.

Ensure you have all the necessary equipment, personal comfort items, and any documentation that might aid your project. Don't forget backup solutions and ways to keep yourself organised and productive throughout the event.

If any members of your team will be participating online, please ensure that you establish communication channels that are best suited to your team's needs yourself. You can use MS Teams, Zoom, Skype etc.

Key Items to Bring

- **Laptop and charger**
- **Notebooks and pens**
- **External hard drives or USB sticks**
- **Headphones for focus**
- **Smartphone and charger**
- **Reusable water bottle**
- **Business cards for networking**

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07. Runsheet & Schedule

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Hackathon Day 1
Monday 19th October

Time	Activity
07:00AM	Registration Open
08:00AM	Welcome, Introduction & Rules from Rimpa Global
08:30AM	Hackathon Commences: Team forming, Q and A, workshops and solution development
03:00PM	First Pitch: Mentors to provide feedback
05:00PM	End of Day 1 - Participants may continue their work remotely

Hackathon Day 2
Tuesday 20th October

Time	Activity
08:00AM	Welcome and Introduction to Day 2
08:15AM	Team Pitch Rehearsal before presenting to the Judges
10:00AM *to Complete*	The Pitch - Each team will present a 5 min pitch and will receive 5 mins of feedback from the Judges
13:30 *to Complete*	Judges Deliberate
05:00PM	Shortlist Finalists Notified

Hackathon Day 3 – Wednesday 21st October

Time	Activity
04:00PM	RIMPA Live 2026 Shortlisted Finalist Presentations on stage for an Audience
06:30PM	Winner Announced at the Diamond Ball (Black-Tie Event)

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08. Judging Criteria

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Judging Criteria



IDEA AND SOLUTION

How creative is the idea behind the solution?

FUNCTIONALITY

Could the solution work? Could it scale as a real-world solution?

FIT

How relevant is the solution to solving a commercial or social problem?

PRESENTATION AND TEAM

How persuasive was the team's pitch? How well balanced and credible is the team?

Remember: For your final presentation, you will only have 5 minutes to pitch & Judges have 5 minutes to ask clarifying questions.

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09. Meet The Judges

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Meet the Judges



JOSEPHINE SECIS
Assistant Director-General, Government Information & Collection Management, NAA.



JAMES PRICE
Managing Director, Experience Matters



GREG LONG
Assistant Director - Maritime Warfare Centre Royal Australian Navy, DoD



CONNI CHRISTENSEN
Founding Partner - The Synercon Group

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10. Meet The Mentors

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The Role of a Mentor

Guidance and Advice: Mentors provide expert advice and guidance on technical, strategic, and creative aspects of the projects. They help participants navigate challenges, clarify their ideas, and refine their approaches.

Encouragement and Motivation: Mentors encourage participants, keeping their morale high throughout the event. They help teams stay focused and motivated.

Problem-Solving Assistance: Mentors assist teams in troubleshooting issues, whether they are technical problems, design challenges, or conceptual hurdles. They offer alternative perspectives and solutions to help teams overcome obstacles.

Knowledge Sharing: Mentors share their knowledge and expertise, providing valuable insights into best practices, industry standards, and innovative techniques that can enhance the participants' projects.

Feedback and Critique: Mentors offer constructive feedback on the participants' ideas and work, helping them improve their projects and better prepare for presentations or judging.

Role Modeling: Mentors serve as role models, demonstrating professionalism, collaboration, and creativity, inspiring participants to grow both personally and professionally.

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Meet the Mentors



ANDREA MCINTOSH
General Manager Global Operations, Leadership Through Data



MICHELLE TOLLIDAY
Chair, ISO/TC 46/SC 11, International Standards Organisation



JOHN COX
Business Development Manager, DatacomIT

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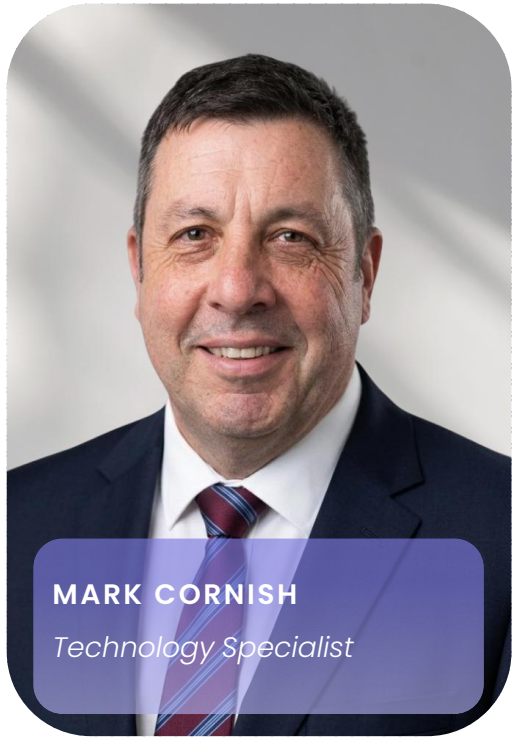
Meet the Mentors



MICHAEL HALEY
Secretary, Global Information Consortium



ERROL LEBOYDRE
Managing Director, WyldLynx



MARK CORNISH
Technology Specialist

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11. Our Exclusive Sponsor

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Our Exclusive Sponsor



Innovation, out-of-the-box thinking, and fresh perspectives are crucial as we look towards the future of information management.

National Archives of Australia, the proud sponsor of the RIMPA Global Hackathon 2026, plays a crucial role in preserving and providing access to the documentary heritage of Australia. As a leading authority in records and information management, National Archives supports innovation and excellence in the industry.

By sponsoring this hackathon, they demonstrate their commitment to fostering new solutions and technologies that enhance digitization, automation, and integration while ensuring the integrity and accessibility of vital records. Their support underscores the importance of this event in driving forward the future of information management practices!

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"Creativity is thinking up new things. Innovation is doing new things"

12. Code of Conduct

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Code of Conduct & Media Release

Media Release

During the event, we will have teams taking photos and video and sharing via social media and related platforms.

By participating you give RIMPA Global permission to use any of these items without your further permissions.

RIMPA Global will, where possible, have regard to your cultural, family and personal sensitivities.

Code Of Conduct

The RIMPA hackathon event is focused on providing a harassment-free experience for everyone, regardless of gender, gender identity and expression, age, sexual orientation, disability, physical appearance, body size, race, ethnicity, nationality, religion, previous hackathon attendance or computing experience (or lack of any of the aforementioned).

We do not tolerate harassment of event participants in any form. Sexual language and imagery is not appropriate at any hackathon venue, including hacks, talks, workshops, parties, social media and other online media. Event participants violating these rules may be sanctioned or expelled from the at the discretion of the organisers.

13. Contact Information

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Get In Touch with RIMPA Global

CONTACT

1800 242 611

admin@rimpa.com.au

OPENING HOURS

Mon – Fri : 08 AM – 05 PM



Connect with Us

facebook.com/RIMPAGlobal

linkedin.com/company/rimpa-global

instagram.com/rimpaglobal

For more info: rimpa.com.au



Thanks